

Community Garden Program - 2026 Season Report

Prepared by the Parks Volunteer Office

Summary

The program ran four sites from April to October. Volunteer turnout grew at every site, and the combined harvest passed 5,000 kg for the first time. Most of the growth came from the two sites that added raised beds and a shared tool shed in spring.

Harvest by site

Site	Plots	Volunteers	Harvest (kg)
Riverside	42	118	1,640
Hillcrest	35	96	1,410
Old Mill	28	71	1,120
Northgate	22	64	910

Findings

What worked

- Raised beds cut weeding time by about a third at Riverside and Hillcrest.
- Weekend workdays brought in more first-time volunteers than weekday evenings.
- A shared tool shed reduced lost equipment to almost zero.

What to change

- Water use peaked in July; two sites need drip irrigation before next season.
- Northgate had the lowest turnout and needs better signage from the bus stop.

Water use

Sites with drip lines used 40 percent less water per plot than sites watered by hand. The office recommends drip irrigation at Old Mill and Northgate, at an estimated cost of 3,800 dollars.

Appendix A: Monthly volunteer hours

All four sites combined.

Month	Hours	New volunteers	Events
April	310	41	3
May	485	37	4
June	620	29	5
July	702	24	5
August	655	18	4
September	540	15	3
October	298	9	2

Source: volunteer sign-in sheets. Figures are fictional sample data.